



SELN Working Document

The State Employment Leadership Network (SELN) is a cross-state cooperative venture of state MR/DD agencies that are committed to improving employment outcomes for adolescents and adults with developmental disabilities. Working documents contain information collected in response to state requests, and federal, state and local initiatives of interest to the SELN membership. They are intended to share work in progress but may not be a comprehensive analysis or compilation. Working documents are updated over time as information changes.

“Employment First” Resource List Revised as of November 1, 2010

Over the last few years the term “employment first” has become widely used to describe how state and local systems across the country articulate the values and philosophy which undergird employment services and supports available to individuals and families. An employment first approach means integrated individual employment is offered before other service options, and that community employment is supported as the priority outcome in policy, practice, and quality management. While the term has become popular in the developmental disability field, the philosophy of Employment First is being applied differently from state to state. Some of these variations are due to differences in rate/reimbursement methodologies and service definitions, and are also due to the catalysts behind employment first in individual states, which include policymakers, legislators, and grassroots groups. In some states, employment first has focused exclusively on intellectual and development disability systems, in other cases employment first has focused on the entire disability community. This list is intended to provide the reader with a broad set of resources and to illustrate the immense range of options in play around the country. The resources below represent both state initiatives and the work of grass-roots coalitions seeking to improve employment outcomes.

General Information

1. APSE PUBLICATIONS

- a. **APSE Employment First Statement:** APSE statement outlining principles of Employment First
<http://www.apse.org/docs/APSE%20Employment%20First%20Statement%20-%20FINAL-1.pdf>
- b. **APSE Employment First White Paper:** “Establishing a National Employment First Agenda” paper from APSE
<http://www.apse.org/docs/Employment%20First%20Paper%20609%5B1%5D.pdf>
- c. **APSE Connections-Employment First:** Article from JTPR APSE Connections advocating a national Employment First agenda



2. **Alliance for Full Participation:** The Alliance for Full Participation (AFP) site contains a number of Employment First documents and updates from various states on their Employment First activities www.allianceforfullparticipation.org
3. **NASDDS Article – Workers First:** Article from June 2009 Community Services Reporter, published by National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services providing an overview of Employment First efforts [www.nasdds.org/pdf/WorkersFirst\(Moseley\).pdf](http://www.nasdds.org/pdf/WorkersFirst(Moseley).pdf)
4. **NTAR Leadership Center Blog:** Blog post on Employment First by Wendy Parent, Kansas University <http://ntarseedingchange.blogspot.com/2010/03/employment-first.html>
5. **ODEP-USDOL Employment First Memo:** January 2009 memo from the US Department of Labor Office of Disability Employment Policy stressing importance of Employment First <http://www.dol.gov/odep/events/employmentfirst/employmentfirst.htm>
6. **SELN Publications**
 - a. **SELN Employment First Publication:** “Q & A’s on State Employment First Policies” - publication from the State Employment Leadership Network (SELN) providing an overview of Employment First, and specific efforts in Colorado, Florida, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, Tennessee, Washington State, Georgia, Minnesota, and Indiana http://selnmembers.org/images/stories/site_documents/dmr%20request%20employment%20policy%203-08rev.pdf
 - b. **SELN Maintaining Focus:** Article from March 2009 Community Services Reporter, published by National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services “Maintaining a Focus on Employment in Tough Economic Times” – intended to encourage state systems to maintain focus on employment despite current economic conditions www.nasdds.org/pdf/MaintainingFocusOnEmployment.pdf

State Specific Information

7. **California**
 - a. **CA Employment First Legislation Overview:** Overview of AB 287 from California State Council on Developmental Disabilities www.scdd.ca.gov/Legislation/AB287/Learnabout-AB287_9-09combined.pdf



13. Kansas

- a. **Kansas Employment First Summary:** Summary of Kansas Employment First efforts and link to materials
<http://www.workinghealthy.org/employmentfirst.html>
- b. **Kansas Employment First Flyer:** Flyer promoting Employment First in Kansas
www.workinghealthy.org/downloads/EmploymentFirstFlyer.pdf
- c. **Kansas Employment First Legislation:** Text of Kansas House Bill 2669 which establishes a statewide policy of employment first for all people with disabilities. Current status (6/10) is that bill has passed House
www.kslegislature.org/bills/2010/26692.pdf
- d. **Kansas Report – Employment First Workgroup:** May 2009 from Employment First Initiative Work Group
www.apse.org/docs/aaaemployment_first_work_group_initial_report.pdf
- e. **Kansas Executive Orders:** Executive orders from the Governor of Kansas issued 8/26/10, related to employment of individuals in the community: <http://governor.ks.gov/issues-a-initiatives/executive-orders/762-10-10>
<http://governor.ks.gov/issues-a-initiatives/executive-orders/761-10-09>

14. Maryland

- a. **Development Disabilities Administration Position Statement on Employment Services -**
http://dhmh.maryland.gov/dda_md/Training/DDA91809.pdf
- b. **Employment First Overview:** Overview of Maryland's Development Disabilities Administration Employment First initiative
www.reinventingquality.org/docs/ColleenGauruder-08.pdf

15. Massachusetts

- a. **MA Employment First Policy:** 2010 policy issuance from Massachusetts Department of Developmental Disability Services
- b. **MA DDS RFQ:** Excerpts from 2009 Massachusetts Department of Developmental Disability Services service provider solicitation, highlighting a shift in Massachusetts to an Employment First Policy

16. Minnesota

- a. **MN Employment First Summit Report I:** Report of 2007 MN Employment First Summit - A Manifesto on the Employment of Minnesotans with Disabilities in the Integrated, Competitive Workforce



www.mnapse.org/Employment-First-Report.pdf

- b. **MN Employment First Summit Report II:** Report of 2008 MN Employment First Summit - A Progress Report on Employment First Performance in Minnesota www.mnapse.org/Employment-First-Report-Summit-2.pdf
- c. **Minnesota Employment First Web Links:**
 - i. **Minnesota Employment Policy Initiative Website:** www.mn-epi.org/main
 - ii. **Minnesota Employment Training & Technical Assistance Website:** www.mntat.org/main
 - iii. **Employment First Blogs:** <http://employment1st.blogspot.com> and <http://www.mn-epi.blogspot.com>

17. New Mexico - Webinar: "Making Employment First a Reality in NM" webinar and text:

<http://www.health.state.nm.us/DDSD/meaningfullife/EmployFirstRsrcs.htm>

18. North Carolina APSE Article: Article from North Carolina APSE calling for an Employment First Policy www.ncapse.org/WhitePaperEmploymentFirst.pdf

19. Oregon DDS Employment First Policy: Oregon Office of Developmental Disability Services Policy on employment for working-age individuals www.dhs.state.or.us/dd/supp_emp/employment-first-policy.pdf

20. Oklahoma DDS Employment Policy: Oklahoma Developmental Disabilities Services employment policy, stating that the optimal goal of waiver services is full-time employment in the community www.okdhs.org/library/policy/oac317/040/07/0001000.htm

21. Pennsylvania

- a. **PA Employment Legislation:** State legislation that mandates access to community employment <http://www.pacode.com/secure/data/055/chapter6000/subchapKtoc.html>
- b. **PA Employment Policy - General:** 2005 policy document from Pennsylvania Office of Mental Retardation on community employment as a priority <http://www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/>



[misc/00-05-07.pdf](#)

- c. **PA Employment Policy – ICFs/MR:** 2005 policy document from Pennsylvania Department of Public welfare on supporting community employment for individuals living in Intermediate Care Facilities for Individuals with Mental Retardation, indicating community employment as a priority without regard to level of disability
<http://www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/icf/00-06-08.pdf>
- d. **PA Employment Policy – 1990:** 1990 policy document from Pennsylvania Office of Mental Retardation directing that community employment be considered as a service option before less integrated, more restricted options
<http://www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/misc/6000-90-06.pdf>

22. Tennessee

- a. **ARC of TN Statement** – Statement from ARC of Tennessee in support of Employment First <http://www.thearctn.org/Employment.php>
- b. **TN DMRS Employment First Statement:** 2003 statement of support from the Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services in support of Tennessee's Employment First! Initiative
- c. **TN DMRS Newsletter 07:** 2007 Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services newsletter containing article on employment first – pp. 3-5
http://tennessee.gov/dids/newsroom/publications/personally_speaking/march_07.pdf
- d. **TN DMRS Provider Manual Excerpt:** Excerpt from 2005 Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services provider manual regarding Employment First, and requirements for vocational evaluation (situational assessment) every three years. To find this excerpt, go to the full manual and search for "Employment First"
http://www.state.tn.us/dids/provider_agencies/Provider%20Manual.pdf
- e. **TN Employment First Overview:** Publication from the Institute for Community Inclusion providing an overview of Tennessee's Employment First policy www.communityinclusion.org/article.php?article_id=202

23. Texas – Legislation (proposed): Text of Texas House Bill 785 requiring that employment services be structured to ensure employment of people with disabilities in integrated settings. Current status (6/10) is that bill has not been acted on - <http://www.statesurge.com/bills/hb-785-texas-452277>



24. Washington

- a. **ICI Pub-Washington WAAP:** Publication from the Institute for Community Inclusion providing an overview of Washington's Working Age Adult Policy
www.communityinclusion.org/article.php?article_id=222
- b. **Washington State Policy:** Washington Division of Developmental Disabilities Working Age Adult Policy
www.dshs.wa.gov/pdf/adsa/ddd/policies/policy4.11.pdf

25. Wisconsin

- a. **WI Employment First Flyer:** Wisconsin APSE Employment First flyer
- b. **WI Employment First Plan 2010:** Wisconsin Employment First plan developed in 2010
- c. **WI Employment First Rationale-FAQ:** Wisconsin APSE rationale and frequently asked questions regarding Employment First
<http://www.wiapse.org/WI%20Employment%20First%20Initiative%20Rationale.doc>
- d. **WI Mission and Values Statement:** Wisconsin Employment First Mission and Values Statement, asking individuals to commit to Employment First

For more information, to suggest additional items for the list or to obtain copies of items not available on the Web please contact:

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